

Pearson Edexcel International GCSE ICT (4IT1)

Paper 1: Online Communities Mock Examination

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Total Marks: 150 Marks

Question 1 (Total: 35 marks)

Social networking communities have experienced significant platform convergence as their functionalities evolve to meet both personal and commercial demands.

(a) State what is meant by an **online community**. (1)

Enter description here...

(b) Define the terms **function** and **features** in the context of digital community frameworks. (2)

Function:

Define function...

Features:

Define features...

(c) Describe the concept of **platform convergence** with reference to professional and personal networks. (2)

Enter description here...

(d) A user sets up a personal profile page on a modern social media network.

(i) Identify **four** categories of information that can be included inside a user profile layout. (4)

1

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3

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2

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4

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(ii) State the primary difference between a platform stream that uses **targeted marketing** and one that utilizes standard **sponsored posts**. (2)

Enter response here...

(e) Explain how a social platform's algorithm uses data to generate **user suggestions** for its members. (2)

Enter explanation here...

(f) When content spreads far beyond its original network, it is described using a specific term.

(i) State the technical term used to describe this rapid dissemination pattern. (1)

Enter term here...

(ii) Describe the feature that enables users to facilitate this wide circulation. (2)

Enter description here...

(g) Social networking sites provide tools for groups, lists, and circles.

Explain **one** benefit to an organization of creating separate communication groups or circles within their network. (2)

Enter explanation here...

(h) Review the business and monetization models behind free-to-use social platforms.

(i) State the revenue question rule regarding the true cost of free networks. (1)

Enter rule here...

(ii) Describe the underlying **targeted marketing** mechanism used to generate income from advertisers. (3)

Enter mechanics description here...

(iii) State how **market scale** influences an advertiser's willingness to purchase promotions. (2)

Enter response here...

(i) Identify **three** functional tools or features that facilitate visible, interactive online conversations between multiple members on a timeline. (3)

List features 1, 2, and 3 here...

(j) State the purpose of an **analytics service** on a social network. (2)

Enter response here...

(k) Identify **one** platform mentioned in the text that functions primarily as a professional network. Place a cross (x) in the correct box. (1)

- ☐ A. Facebook
- ☐ B. Twitter
- ☐ C. LinkedIn
- ☐ D. Baidu

Question 2 (Total: 30 marks)

Online workspaces and interactive entertainment platforms rely on specialized features to connect users globally.

(a) Define the primary function of an **online gaming community**. (1)

Enter definition here...

(b) State the full meaning of the acronym **MMORPG**. (1)

Enter acronym meaning...

(c) Online gaming profiles track metrics to help players select appropriate opponents. Identify this metric and explain how it influences matchmaking within the community. (2)

Enter identity and explanation...

(d) List **four** distinct features found inside gaming community platforms that support tactics discussion or community engagement. (4)

List features here...

(e) Collaborative business operations depend heavily on cloud-hosted environments.

(i) State the function of **online workspaces**. (1)

Enter function...

(ii) Describe how **simultaneous multi-user document editing** changes how files are developed by a team. (2)

Enter description...

(iii) Identify **three** utility systems or booking features embedded within workspaces to manage corporate resources or coordination timelines. (3)

List utility features here...

(f) Virtual workspaces provide multi-user environments for real-time remote communication.

Identify **three** communication or video conferencing tools combined within virtual meeting spaces. (3)

List tools here...

(g) Explain how a workspace's **shared calendar** feature assists a project manager in arranging meetings. (2)

Enter explanation here...

(h) Differentiate between the primary objectives of an **online workspace** and an **online gaming community**. (4)

Provide comparative response metrics here...

(i) Identify **two** examples of online workspaces mentioned in the text. (2)

List two examples...

Question 3 (Total: 30 marks)

Educational institutions and reference repositories deploy user-generated content spaces to distribute learning materials and document files.

(a) State the full meaning of the acronym **VLE**. (1)

Enter acronym meaning...

(b) Compare **VLEs** with standard online workspaces, highlighting their structural similarities and target audience limitations. (3)

Enter comparative overview...

(c) A VLE utilizes a single sign-on system to streamline student access.

(i) Define the term **single sign-on (SSO)**. (2)

Enter definition...

(ii) Identify the tracking tool that allows teachers to monitor how frequently students interact with these online modules. (1)

Enter identity of tool...

(d) List **four** core toolsets or assessment features present within a standard VLE portal. (4)

List toolsets here...

(e) User-generated reference sites rely on community collaborations to compile large encyclopedias.

(i) Define the term **wiki**. (1)

Enter definition...

(ii) Describe the feature that allows an authorized editor to alter a wiki page's layout directly. (2)

Enter description...

(iii) State why member accounts are tracking prerequisites on a wiki platform. (2)

Enter statement...

(f) Discussion boards organize forum interactions around targeted conversation pathways.

(i) State the technical term used to describe a series of sorted messages concerning the same subject. (1)

Enter technical term...

(ii) Explain the purpose of a **sticky note (sticky)** thread on a forum board. (2)

Enter explanation...

(iii) Differentiate between the system privileges held by a forum **Moderator** and an **Administrator**. (3)

Detail specific user permission parameters...

(g) Forums apply automated scanning software to filter inappropriate text or dangerous links before publication.

(i) Identify this safety screening feature. (1)

Enter safety feature name...

(ii) List **two** other safety or reporting features members can use to manage rule-breakers. (2)

List options here...

(h) Define the function of a **social bookmarking site**. (2)

Enter definition here...

(i) State the specific condition under which individual blogs or vlogs are officially classified as **communities**. (2)

Enter condition context here...

Question 4: Technical Comparison Matrix (Total: 30 marks)

An IT consultant is preparing a comprehensive structural matrix evaluating the profiles, functions, and target parameters of various online spaces.

Part A: Evaluating Community Profiles and Functions

Community Framework	Core Intended Function / Target Activities	Sourced Example from Text
Social Networking	Allows members to connect through shared interests or relationships.	Facebook or Baidu
Online Work Space	(a) Enter definition / focus indicators...	Slack or Microsoft SharePoint
Virtual Learning (VLE)	(b) Enter function metrics...	Google Classroom or Moodle
Video-Sharing Platform	Allows users to access and share content created and uploaded by members.	(c) Sourced example...

Part B: Defining Staging, Tags, and Web Logs

Technical Concept	Core Operational Feature / Performance Criteria	Sourced Vocabulary Definition
Social Bookmarking	(d) Enter feature context...	Using tags to categorize web documents and URLs for searchable lookups.
Blog (Web Log)	A website or web page updated regularly, written like a diary or a series of articles.	(e) Enter definition context...
Geotagging Leak	(f) Enter operational flaw mechanics...	Accidentally giving away location data by uploading images carrying metadata.

Question 5: Extended Response Essay (Total: 25 marks)

An international media training academy wants to launch a global online network. The platform must allow remote students to edit co-authored production scripts, view training videos, participate in peer evaluations on forums, track progress scores, and sync personal profiles wirelessly.

The technology directors are choosing between two architecture deployment strategies:

- **Option A:** Implementing a highly converged, public Social Networking architecture combined with open video-sharing content management systems (CMS), wiki reference platforms, and open social bookmarking tools to maximize reach and peer engagement.
- **Option B:** Deploying a secure, closed Virtual Learning Environment (VLE) integrated with private online workspace channels. This model restricts content access via Single Sign-On (SSO), limits interactions to internal networks, and runs automated content-censoring filters managed by designated administrators.

Evaluate both options. You should discuss the impacts of each option on **data privacy** (including prevention of geotagging leaks or location disclosure), **collaborative workflow efficiency** (such as multi-user document creation), **user safety** (mitigating cyberbullying or anonymous misrepresentation), and the platform's **long-term administration overheads**. (25)

Plan your answer carefully. Marks will be awarded for structured layout, correct usage of ICT vocabulary from the text, balanced evaluation points, and a logical final conclusion.

Enter your extended response essay response here...